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Mohammad: Emirates a symbol of national pride

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, stressed that Emirates has become one of the world's leading airlines and a key pillar of the UAE's development, as the carrier marks the 40th anniversary of its establishment.

In a post on the social platform X, Shaikh Mohammad commended the airline's journey since its first flight on October 25, 1985.

"Forty years ago, on October 25, 1985, the first Emirates flight took off, carrying with it great ambitions that soared toward the sky," Shaikh Mohammad wrote. He said Emirates today stands as "one of our national symbols of pride, a key driver of our development journey, and one of the most important airlines in the world."

He extended his gratitude to Shaikh Ahmad Bin Saeed Al Maktoum, Chairman and Chief Executive of Emirates Airline and Group, and to the airline's more than 100,000 employees, praising their dedication and relentless efforts.

Shaikh Hamdan Bin Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister, Minister of Defence, and Chairman of The Executive Council of Dubai, also lauded the carrier in a post on X.

SEE ALSO P11

RTA reshapes Dubai as smart and sustainable transport hub

CELEBRATES 20 YEARS OF SHAPING CITY'S FUTURE, ENHANCING QUALITY OF LIFE

DUBAI

BY ASHFAQ AHMED
Managing Editor

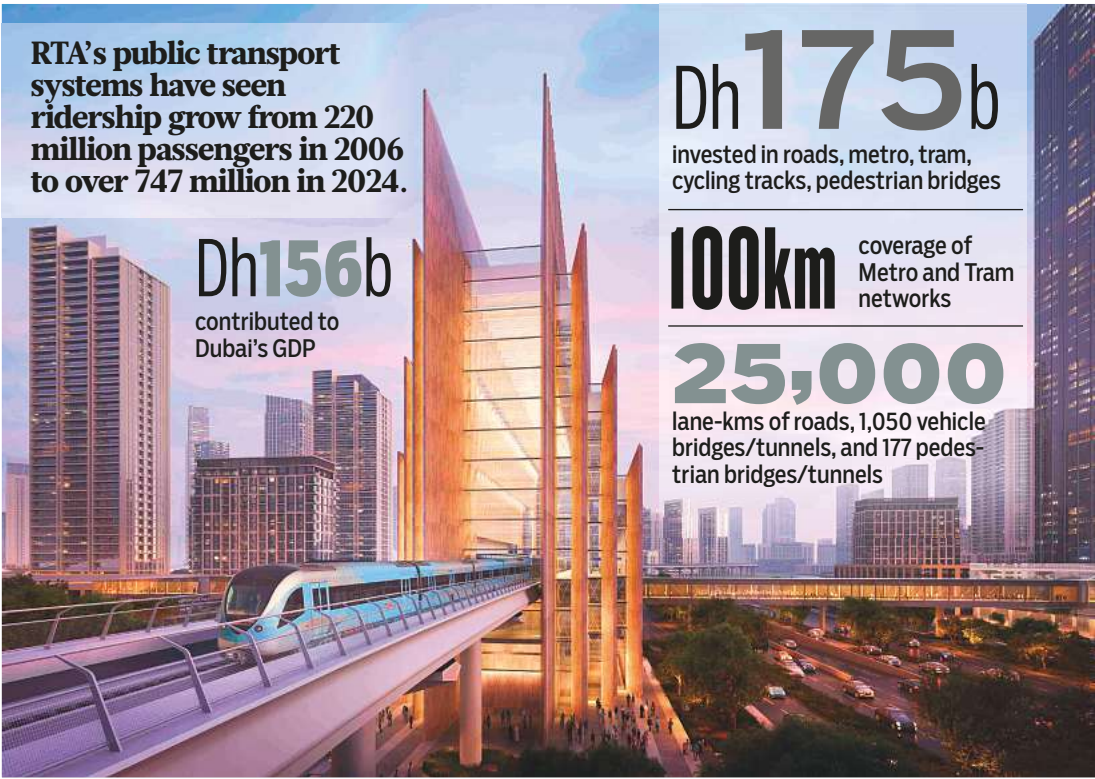
Dubai's Roads and Transport Authority (RTA) celebrated its 20th anniversary, reflecting on two decades of transformative achievements that have reshaped the emirate's urban mobility, boosted the economy, and positioned Dubai as a global hub for smart and sustainable transport.

Mattar Al Tayer, Director General and Chairman of the Board of Executive Directors of RTA, highlighted the role of visionary leadership in guiding these successes. "Under the guidance and support of our wise leadership, we have built an integrated infrastructure of road networks and public transport systems that has strengthened Dubai's global competitiveness and enhanced quality of life across the emirate," he said.

World-class road network

Over the past 20 years, RTA has invested Dh175 billion in developing Dubai's infrastructure, including roads, metro lines, trams, cycling tracks, and pedestrian pathways. Its world-class road network spans more than 25,000 lane-kilometres, supporting 3.5 million vehicles daily, while the Dubai Metro and Tram together cover more than 100 kilometres. Pedestrian bridges and tunnels have increased from 26 in 2006 to 177 by 2024, improving accessibility and safety for residents.

RTA's public transport systems have seen ridership grow from 220 million passengers in 2006



■ Over the past 20 years, RTA has invested billions of dirhams in developing Dubai's infrastructure, including roads, metro lines, trams, cycling tracks, and pedestrian pathways.

to over 747 million in 2024, with public transport now accounting for 21.6 per cent of daily movements, compared to just 6 per cent in 2006. "The development of public transport is founded on integration, ensuring smooth and seamless mobility across Dubai," Al Tayer noted.

RTA has placed human capital at the heart of its strategy, employing more than 400 Emirati engineers and specialists in technical fields such as smart traffic systems, artificial intelligence, data science, and autonomous

transport. Al Tayer emphasised, "Investing in people forms the cornerstone of sustainable development. We have launched programmes to prepare young national leaders, enhancing their foresight and innovation capabilities to lead the next phase of RTA's journey."

Al Tayer noted the broader economic value of RTA's enterprises: "Four commercial companies established by RTA — Salik, Parkin, Dubai Taxi, and Mada Media — now have a combined market value exceeding Dh80

billion. These companies stand as models for turning government assets into sustainable economic enterprises."

Looking ahead, RTA plans to focus on five strategic pillars: investing in infrastructure with AI integration, adopting sustainable and autonomous transport solutions, developing business models to foster start-ups, attracting future talent, and strengthening partnerships with local and global private sector entities.

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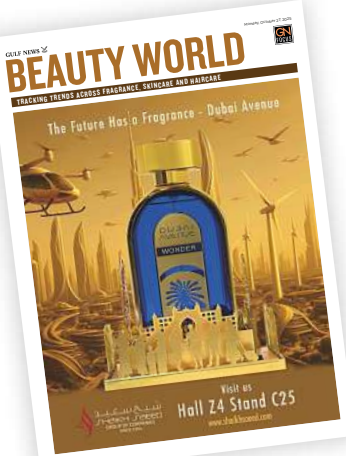
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INDIA

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Dubai to get a new Museum of Art — and it will float on water

The new landmark will be located on the waters of Dubai Creek

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

Dubai is set to get a new architectural and cultural landmark, the Dubai Museum of Art (DUMA).

DUMA will be developed by the Al Futtaim Group on the waters of Dubai Creek. It will embody Dubai's vision as a global capital of the creative economy and reflect the emirate's growing cultural and artistic momentum.

The museum's design, crafted by world-renowned Japanese architect Tadao Ando, blends the essence of deep-rooted local culture with modern architecture. It emphasises the key qualities of symbolic meaning, human-centered dimensions, dynamic purpose,



and strong appeal to artists and art enthusiasts, offering a sensory experience that transcends the confines of physical space.

Five-storey tall

Rising five stories above the water, the museum will feature adaptable exhibition galleries across the first and second floors, a restaurant and VIP lounge on the third floor, as well as ground and basement levels. Beyond its exhibitions, the Museum will host artist talks, panel discussions, educational programmes, and art fairs.

Purpose-built event spaces and a dedicated VIP lounge will enable a curated calendar of cultural programming that fosters learning, dialogue, and creative innovation.

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